Web-Based Material Management Systems: A Literature Review and a Proposed Implementation

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***Abstract*—Material management depends on accurate stock records, clear responsibility and traceable transactions. This focused narrative review examines 16 peer-reviewed studies on construction material control, automated tracking, cloud and BIM integration, and digital supply chains. The literature shows substantial work on RFID-based identification and location, as well as broader studies of digital coordination; it does not support a claim that inventory software is absent in general. The paper positions the DecoStone capstone Material Management System as a transaction-focused web application for material records, issue and return, role-based access, dashboards and reports across godowns. The application uses HTML, CSS, JavaScript, Node.js, Express.js and SQLite. The supplied project record reports local functional checks for login, issue and return; it does not report performance, usability or security evaluation. The review therefore distinguishes implemented scope from future work and identifies evaluation priorities.**

Keywords—material management, inventory control, warehouse operations, web application, role-based access, literature review

I. INTRODUCTION

Organizations depend on equipment and materials to carry out their daily work. Accurate information about where materials are, who has taken them and when they were returned is needed for coordination, resource planning and accountability.

When material records are kept in registers, spreadsheets or separate applications, finding information and preparing reports becomes slow. Managers may have to check several records to see

the stock position, and store staff may have to match issue and return entries by hand.

Digital approaches to material control range from database-centered inventory applications to RFID, GPS, BIM and cloud-enabled tracking [1]–[16]. These approaches address different operating contexts and should not be treated as interchangeable. A location-tracking pilot, for example, answers different questions from a system that records who issued stock, to which location and whether it was returned.

This paper has three aims: to synthesize relevant research, define the practical scope of the DecoStone capstone system, and identify evidence still needed to evaluate it. Section II explains the review scope and discusses the literature by theme. Section III compares representative studies, Section IV positions the project relative to that evidence, Section V describes the system and its reported checks, and Section VI concludes with future work.

II. LITERATURE REVIEW

Review scope and approach. This is a focused narrative review, not a protocol-based systematic review. Peer-reviewed journal and conference papers were selected from publisher pages and institutional repositories using combinations of material management, inventory, construction logistics, RFID, BIM, cloud tracking and digital supply chain. The set includes foundational tracking work and reviews published through 2026. Selection favored studies that describe a system, field case, framework or review relevant to material records and movement. The summaries below report each study's stated method and scope; they do not imply that every cited system was independently replicated.

A. Inventory and Material-Control Frameworks

Kasim [2] used a literature review and exploratory case studies to frame ICT-enabled material tracking and inventory control for complex projects. Ren, Anumba and Tah [3] then presented RFID-facilitated management across planning, ordering, inventory, site use and monitoring in a water-supply project. Lee et al. [5] organized RFID control around material types and lifecycle checkpoints and demonstrated the framework in construction-site trials. These works emphasize that reliable stock information depends on recording events across the material lifecycle, although their evidence and workflows are specific to construction settings and RFID-supported processes. Moon et al. [9] examined supplier-side scaffold stock in an Australasian supply chain. The case illustrates how tracking can extend beyond the construction site to suppliers, but its focus on scaffolding and a particular supplier limits direct transfer to general-purpose stock operations.

B. Automated Identification, Location and Visibility

Song, Haas and Caldas [1] proposed automatic RFID-based material location using readers carried by field supervisors or handling equipment together with GPS. Demiralp et al. [4] studied RFID for prefabricated components through a supply-chain case and simulation, highlighting that adoption also raises questions about investment and cost sharing. Valero et al. [6] reviewed RFID applications across construction phases and mapped a broad, technically focused evidence base. Ko, Azambuja and Lee [7] developed a cloud-based tracking prototype combining RFID and barcodes for small and medium contractors, with simulation and feasibility evaluations. Fang et al. [8] integrated RFID localization, BIM visualization and cloud services and tested the system on a full-scale construction site, including localization accuracy, latency and remote viewing. Together, these studies show how automated identification can improve visibility, while also showing that location-level tracking depends on tags, readers, site infrastructure and integration with project data.

C. Planning, Supply-Chain Coordination and Recent Reviews

Kasim et al. [10] used case studies and practitioner interviews to examine material-tracking practice in Malaysian construction projects; they reported continued reliance on manual processes and basic ICT in the studied context. Chen et al. [11] linked BIM and RFID data with look-ahead plans to align site demand and material supply. Zhao et al. [12] combined real-time indoor tracking of workers and material kits with schedule data in a renovation case, enabling analysis of whether kits and labor reached work locations as planned. These studies connect inventory visibility to planning, but their applications rely on construction-specific schedules, tracking infrastructure or case conditions.

At a broader level, Yevu, Yu and Darko [13] used mixed review methods to map digital supply-chain and procurement research in the built environment, identifying fragmentation and integration needs. Liao, Yang and Quan [14] reviewed construction supply-chain management, analyzing a large article set quantitatively and a focused subset qualitatively to develop a resilience-oriented framework. Antai, Lenka and Achtenhagen [15] synthesized research on digital-platform adoption and integration in AEC, while Lopes and Turkan [16] reviewed 53 studies on RFID-BIM integration for circular construction. The recent reviews reinforce interoperability, data integration and stakeholder adoption as persistent themes. Their scope is broader than day-to-day warehouse transactions, and the RFID-BIM review remains centered on digitally tracked construction assets.

TABLE I

COMPARISON OF THE REVIEWED PAPERS

No.	Author, Year	Method / Technology	Advantage	Limitation
1	Zhao et al., 2021 [12]	Real-time indoor tracking of workers and material kits with schedule data	Links material presence with planned work	Single renovation case; tracking infrastructure required
2	Ren et al., 2011 [3]	RFID-based material planning, inventory, site use and monitoring	Connects several material-control stages	Water-supply case and RFID-specific workflow
3	Moon et al., 2018 [9]	RFID tracking for scaffold-supplier stock	Extends visibility into supplier stock	Specialized supplier and material context
4	Ko et al., 2016 [7]	Cloud prototype integrating RFID and barcodes	Designed for accessible SMB contractor tracking	Tags and readers remain part of the solution
5	Fang et al., 2016 [8]	BIM, cloud and RFID indoor localization	Tests location, latency and remote visualization	Site infrastructure and BIM integration required
6	Chen et al., 2020 [11]	BIM-RFID workflow with look-ahead plans	Matches site demand with material supply	Depends on planning and tracking data
7	Liao et al., 2023 [14]	Systematic review of construction supply-chain management	Maps resilience and integration themes	Broad sector review; not a product evaluation
8	Antai et al., 2025 [15]	Systematic review of digital platforms in AEC	Explains adoption and integration themes	Not focused on warehouse stock transactions

III. COMPARISON OF THE STUDIES

Table I summarizes eight representative papers from the 16-study review. The studies differ in purpose and evidence: some propose tracking frameworks, others test prototypes or field deployments, and recent reviews synthesize wider research trends. Their shared emphasis is better information visibility, but the technologies, users and evaluation settings vary. The project should therefore be compared by workflow and scope, rather than by assuming that a tracking pilot is equivalent to a complete inventory application.

IV. PROJECT POSITION

The reviewed literature includes inventory frameworks, RFID and barcode prototypes, supplier and construction-site cases, BIM-cloud integrations, and broader supply-chain reviews. It would be inaccurate to claim that web-based or integrated inventory systems do not exist: Ko et al. [7], for example, describe a cloud-based materials-tracking prototype. The more precise contribution of the DecoStone project is its application to routine stock transactions and role-based workflows across godowns, without requiring physical tracking hardware.

For this capstone, the practical distinctions and remaining evidence needs are:

1) Operating context: Much of the reviewed empirical work concerns construction projects, prefabricated components, or specialized suppliers. The project instead addresses routine material records and stock transactions across multiple storage locations.

2) Technology choice: RFID, GPS, BIM and cloud systems add physical tracking or model integration. The current project is a browser-based, transaction-recording application; it does not identify or locate materials automatically.

3) Workflow focus: The system brings material records, issue and return, role-based access, dashboard information and reports into one application. This is a project-specific combination and should not be presented as a first-of-its-kind result.

4) Evaluation: The available test record confirms only login, material issue and return in a local environment. Tests of role permissions, reports, stock reconciliation, concurrent use, security and usability are still needed before broader operational claims can be made.

V. PROPOSED WORK

A. System Overview

The DecoStone capstone Material Management System is intended to maintain material records and support routine stock operations across godowns. Its stated modules include material inventory, material issue and return, role-based login, an administrative dashboard and reports. It uses a web application and relational database rather than RFID, GPS or automated physical identification. These boundaries distinguish the project's current scope from the tracking and coordination technologies reviewed above.

B. Technologies and Architecture

HTML structures the pages, CSS controls presentation and JavaScript supports browser interactions. Node.js and Express.js handle application requests and logic, while SQLite stores

application data. The architecture in Fig. 1 shows the browser-facing presentation layer, the server-side application layer and the database layer. This description reflects the supplied project synopsis; it is not a deployment or security assessment.

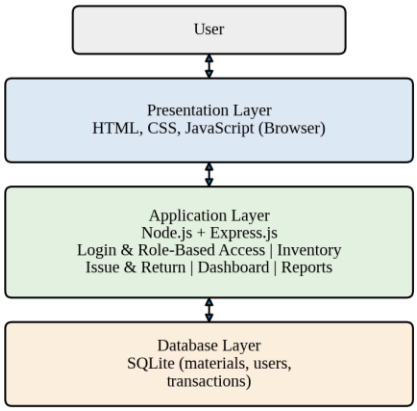


Fig. 1. Three-layer architecture of the Material Management System.

C. Modules

The inventory module maintains material records. Issue and return operations record stock leaving and re-entering storage. Authentication and role-based authorization are intended to restrict functions according to assigned access. The dashboard summarizes operational information, and reports present views derived from stored records. The paper reports that the application supports these modules, but the recorded functional checks cover only login, issue and return.

D. Development Method

The project work followed six stages: requirements identification, frontend development, backend development, database integration, module integration and functional checking. The stages describe the development sequence; no formal process-improvement or comparative study is claimed.

E. Functional Checks

The supplied project record states that the application was checked on a local computer for the three workflows listed in Table II. No independent test log or quantitative performance measurements were provided in the source paper.

TABLE II
OBSERVED TEST OUTCOMES

Test case	Observed outcome	Status
Login	Login worked during testing	Passed
Material issue	Issue operation worked	Passed
Material return	Return operation worked	Passed

The three reported workflows passed in that local check. This evidence does not establish that every module or route works correctly, nor does it measure inventory accuracy, response time, concurrent-user behavior or user satisfaction. Further testing should use documented inputs, expected results and database-state checks.

F. Security and Deployment Considerations

Before deployment, the application should be assessed for password hashing, server-side authorization on every protected operation,

parameterized database access, input validation, session and cookie settings, error handling, backup and restore, and transport security. These are review recommendations only; the supplied test record does not demonstrate that they are implemented or security-tested.

VI. CONCLUSION AND FUTURE SCOPE

Conclusion. This review synthesized 16 studies covering material-control frameworks, construction tracking technologies, cloud and BIM integration, and digital supply-chain research. The evidence does not justify a broad claim that integrated inventory software is absent. Instead, the DecoStone capstone is positioned as a transaction-focused web application for routine material records and role-based operations across godowns. The supplied local test record confirms login, issue and return only; further testing is required before making claims about complete functionality, quality or operational benefit.

Future Scope. Future evaluation should document test cases for every role and route, verify stock balances against transaction history, reconcile the database with physical counts, and test backup recovery, concurrent use, security and mobile usability. Performance and user feedback should be measured with a defined test plan. Barcode or QR scanning and notifications may be considered later if operational requirements justify them.

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